authorized participants initiate the requests. Agents can be human or software applications.

TRANSACTIONS

A typical process of buying flight seats may involve many operations and interactions with various subsystems, such as databases. Let's refer to operations that need to be verified, validated, confirmed, and recorded by all parties as the transactions, or simply Txs.

RULES

The contract diagram in figure 2.11 (section 2.7) shows new elements that did not appear in the counter use case: modifiers. *Modifiers* are special elements of a smart contract, representing the rules that act as gatekeepers to control access to data and functions. Only valid members (`onlyMember`) can transact on the system, and only the chairperson (`onlyChairperson`) can unregister any airline.

> **DEFINITION** *Modifiers* are a language feature that supports explicit specification of rules for validation and verification. These modifiers are the gatekeepers that do the verification and validation, and thus are specifically meant for realizing trust.

Recall from chapter 1 that the blockchain is a trust intermediator, which means that it automates the process of verification and validation for trust establishment in its code (smart contracts). Modifiers are features that enable this trust intermediation. Here's how it works: